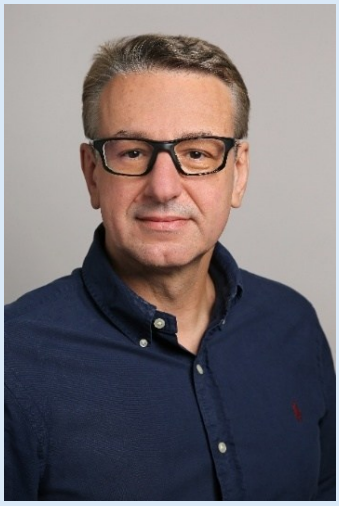

Elson Felix Mendes Filho

AI & Machine Learning Engineer

CONTACT

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github.com/ElsonFilho

PERSONAL INFORMATION

Brazilian and Portuguese

C EU/EFTA Swiss permit
(Settled foreign nationals)

Married

1 child (17.04.2010)

LANGUAGE SKILLS

Portuguese: Native

English: Full professional proficiency

German: Elementary proficiency

PROFESSIONAL PROFILE

Senior AI & Machine Learning Engineer with extensive hands-on experience deploying AI solutions for Fortune 500 clients across Life Sciences, Financial Services, Manufacturing, and Commercial sectors throughout Europe and Latin America.

Production-proven expertise: Delivered end-to-end AI solutions in environments where precision and reliability are non-negotiable. Use cases span fraud detection systems, predictive diagnostics, customer intelligence, and predictive maintenance. Deep technical breadth spanning traditional ML, Deep Learning, NLP, Computer Vision, and cutting-edge Generative AI, LLMs, and Agentic AI.

Technical leadership with business acumen: Contributed to multi-million-dollar engagements by translating complex AI capabilities into executive strategy and production solutions. Built and managed analytics teams and actively mentored the next generation of Data Scientists at Swiss and European universities. Combine hands-on technical depth with cross-functional leadership.

TECHNICAL SKILLS SUMMARY

- **AI & ML**: GenAI, LLMs, RAG, Agentic AI, Transformer Architectures, Deep Learning, NLP, Computer Vision
- **Data Science**: Predictive Modeling, Time Series, Anomaly Detection, Data Visualization
- **Programming**: Python, R, SAS, SQL, Spark
- **Frameworks:** Scikit-learn, PyTorch, TensorFlow, Keras, LangChain, Hugging Face
- **MLOps & Cloud**: AWS, Azure, GCP, Model Deployment, CI/CD Pipelines

WHAT I BRING

I bridge the gap between AI possibility and business reality, delivering production systems in high-stakes environments by combining technical rigor with strategic thinking. Working independently and with cross-functional teams, I help organizations achieve transformative outcomes without the costly missteps of misaligned execution.

WORK EXPERIENCE

Customer Advisor – Data Science
SAS Institute Switzerland – Wallisellen, Switzerland
August 2011 – November 2024

Provided dedicated **sales support** for major accounts in the **Commercial** and **Life Sciences** sectors. Established **strategic visions** and **tailored value propositions** on AI and Data Science offerings, contributing to several **multi-million-dollar deals** for software and consulting services. Spearheaded **workshops** to educate internal teams and customers on leveraging **Data Visualization**, **Predictive Analytics**, and **Artificial Intelligence** to maximize the benefits of the solutions.

Led **business development** by identifying and qualifying new opportunities and developing **strategic plans** and **proposals**. Designed and delivered **demos** showcasing new functionalities, and executed **Proofs of Concept, Proofs of Value, pilots, and full projects** using **innovative approaches** across multiple industries and use cases. Integrated SAS with open-source ecosystems (**Python, R**) and Large Language Models (**LLMs**) to enable advanced analytics, natural language interfaces, and AI-driven decision support, increasing technical flexibility, market differentiation, and revenue growth.

Managed and mentored **cross-functional teams**, aligning objectives with **business goals** while fostering **innovation and continuous learning**. Built and nurtured **trust-based relationships** with **customers**, strategic **partners**, and **academic institutions**, supporting long-term business partnerships.

Business Development Manager and Customer Intelligence Practice Manager
SAS Institute Portugal – Lisbon, Portugal
August 2006 – August 2011

Business Development Manager: Responsible for business development **plans, qualification, vision** and **approach** definitions for **Fraud Management** and **Customer Life-Time Value** initiatives. Developed Proof of Values that secured **multi-million-dollar deals**.

Customer Intelligence Practice Manager: Led the Customer Intelligence and Analytics (Data Science and AI) practice, defining **strategic approaches** and developing **tailored proposals** for **projects** while aligning **scope, effort, and objectives** with customer needs. **Structured and expanded the team** from two to nine members through strategic hiring and comprehensive training programs. **Mentored** consultants on technical methodologies and project execution, providing **leadership and quality assurance** across **complex enterprise-level projects** to ensure successful delivery.

Service Lines Manager, Project Manager and Senior Consultant
SAS Institute Brazil – São Paulo, Brazil
April 2002 – August 2006

Service Lines Manager: Managed a team of **30 consultants** across the South Region, overseeing **recruitment, resource allocation, career development, and performance evaluation**. Led **process improvements**, tracked **KPIs**, and provided **mentorship** to support service delivery and professional growth.

Project Manager: Implemented **technical and project management methodologies**, tracking project **portfolios** to ensure timely delivery and alignment with client goals. **Planned and managed complex projects** including Credit Scoring, Campaign Management, Analytical CRM, Demand Forecasting, and Fraud Detection for major companies in telecommunications, retail, banking, financial services, and manufacturing.

Data Mining Senior Consultant: Led consulting projects with emphasis on Data Mining, supporting **pre-sales and post-sales** of SAS solutions. Delivered **lectures and training** to clients and internal teams.

Senior Consultant
Arthur Andersen Business Consulting – São Paulo, Brazil
February 2000 – April 2002

Led **consulting projects** including development of **e-Business and e-Learning strategies**, selection of **outsourcing solution providers**, and evaluation of **collection solutions** for retail banking and **call center systems**. Responsible for establishing and managing the **SAS Partnership**.

EDUCATION

Certificate of Advanced Studies in Generative AI
2025 – 2026
University of Zurich, Center for Continuing Education, Zurich, Switzerland

Master of Science in Computer Science
1995 – 1997
University of São Paulo (ICMSC-USP), São Carlos, Brazil
Specialization: Artificial Intelligence - Neural Networks

Bachelor of Science in Computer Science
1990 – 1994
São Paulo State University (IBILCE-UNESP), São José do Rio Preto, Brazil

CERTIFICATIONS

- **IBM Generative AI Engineering Professional Certificate** (2025)
- **Agile Project Management** – University of Colorado Boulder (2025)
- **CrewAI Multi-Agent Systems** – DeepLearning.AI (2025)
- **Google AI Essentials** (2025)
- **PyTorch Basics** (2021)
- **R Programming** – Johns Hopkins University (2015)
- **Advanced Analytics for Customer Intelligence** – Heidelberg, Germany (2012)
- **SAS Fraud Framework**: **SAS Financial Crimes Monitor & Network Analysis** (2012)
- **Global PSD Methodologies** – Lisbon, Portugal (2010)
- **MS Project Advanced** – São Paulo, Brazil (2005)
- **Advanced Predictive Modeling Using SAS EMiner** – Las Vegas, USA (2004)

CORE COMPETENCIES

Technical Skills

AI & Machine Learning
Generative AI, LLMs, RAG, Agentic AI, Deep Learning, CNNs, Transformer Architectures, Prompt Engineering, NLP, Computer Vision, Predictive Modeling, Recommendation Systems, Anomaly Detection, Fraud Detection, Time Series Forecasting, Ethical AI Practices

Data Science & Analytics
Data Collection & Preprocessing, Data Profiling, Feature Engineering, Statistical Modeling, A/B Testing, Experimentation Design, Data Visualization (Power BI, Tableau, SAS Visual Analytics)

Programming & Frameworks
Python, R, SAS, SQL, Spark, Pandas, PyTorch, TensorFlow, Keras, Scikit-learn, LangChain, Hugging Face, Vector Databases

MLOps & Cloud Platforms
AWS, Azure, GCP, IBM Cloud, Model Deployment & CI/CD Pipelines, Monitoring & Troubleshooting, Version Control (Git/GitHub)

Leadership and Business Skills

Team Leadership & Management
Built and scaled analytics teams, managed consultants across regions, mentoring and career development, cross-functional team collaboration

Business Development & Strategy
Multi-million-dollar deal closures, strategic planning, proposal development and qualification, partnership development, PoC/PoV/Pilot/Project execution

Project & Stakeholder Management
Agile and Waterfall methodologies, portfolio management, stakeholder relationship building and engagement, workshop facilitation, technical presentations to executive audiences

Industry Applications

Life Sciences & Healthcare (Clinical Studies, Real World Evidence, Predictive Diagnostics, APQR, CAPA), **Financial Services** (Fraud Detection, Financial Crimes Monitoring, Network Analysis), **Commercial** (Customer Intelligence, Marketing Analytics, Customer Lifetime Value), **Manufacturing** (Predictive Maintenance, Root Cause Analysis, Demand Forecasting)

HOBBIES AND INTERESTS

Traveling and experiencing different cultures, photography, videography, guitar, cycling